



Battling with China

A Vietnamese soldier captures a Chinese tank driver in Vietnam's Cao Bang province. While the province's mountains had offered protection to Vietnamese communists for decades, Chinese troops invaded the city of Cao Bang in 1979.

Cambodia and Laos

A peace agreement signed in 1991—yet again in Paris—brought an end to Vietnam's occupation of Cambodia and allowed the countries in the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) to increase their economic activity with Vietnam. In 1995, Vietnam became a member of the organization, and also restored its diplomatic relations with the United States.

Cambodia and Laos fared less well after 1991. The Khmer Rouge disaster, Vietnamese occupation, and continuing civil war in Cambodia prevented stability and development. In 1992, the United Nations Transitional Authority in Cambodia (UNTAC), negotiating Vietnamese withdrawal from Cambodia, accepted a mandate to administer the country, organize an election, and address the Khmer Rouge's crimes. Laos remained under Vietnamese control, but had a civil war of its own to fight, between the Lao People's Army—with Vietnamese allies—and a Hmong insurgency.